

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

UNIVERSITY OF CENTRAL

ARKANSAS

TRADITIONAL

On-Site Review: February 19-20, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two

BELOW

Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

UNIVERSITY OF CENTRAL ARKANSAS

TRADITIONAL

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, and particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2b)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The traditional program at UCA has specific plans for continuous improvement in promoting both the number and quality of teacher candidates.

INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	-8.8%	APPROACHING

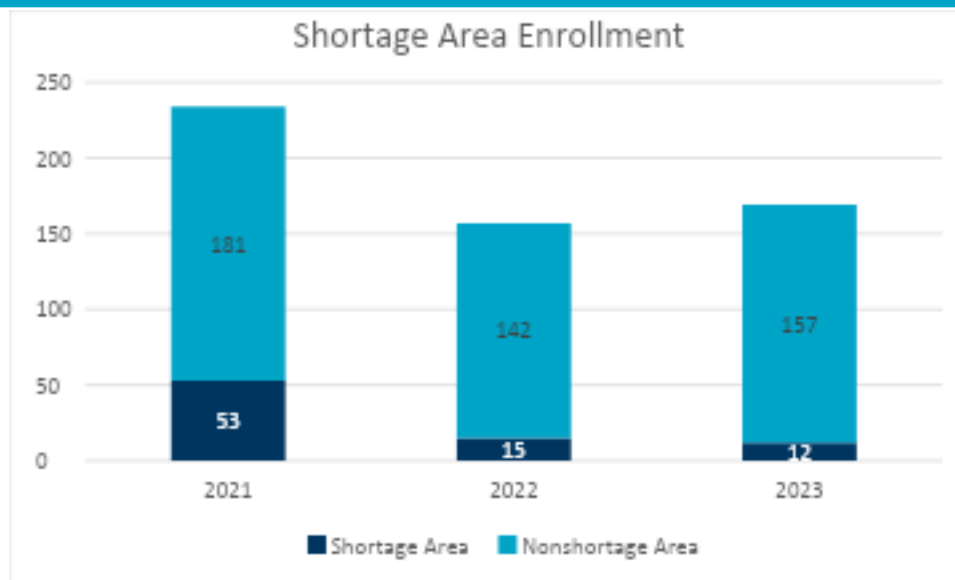
Enrollment

Metric is the percentage growth between the blue and green boxes.

Year	Enrollment
2018	191
2019	261
2020	174
2021	231
2022	157
2023	169

*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

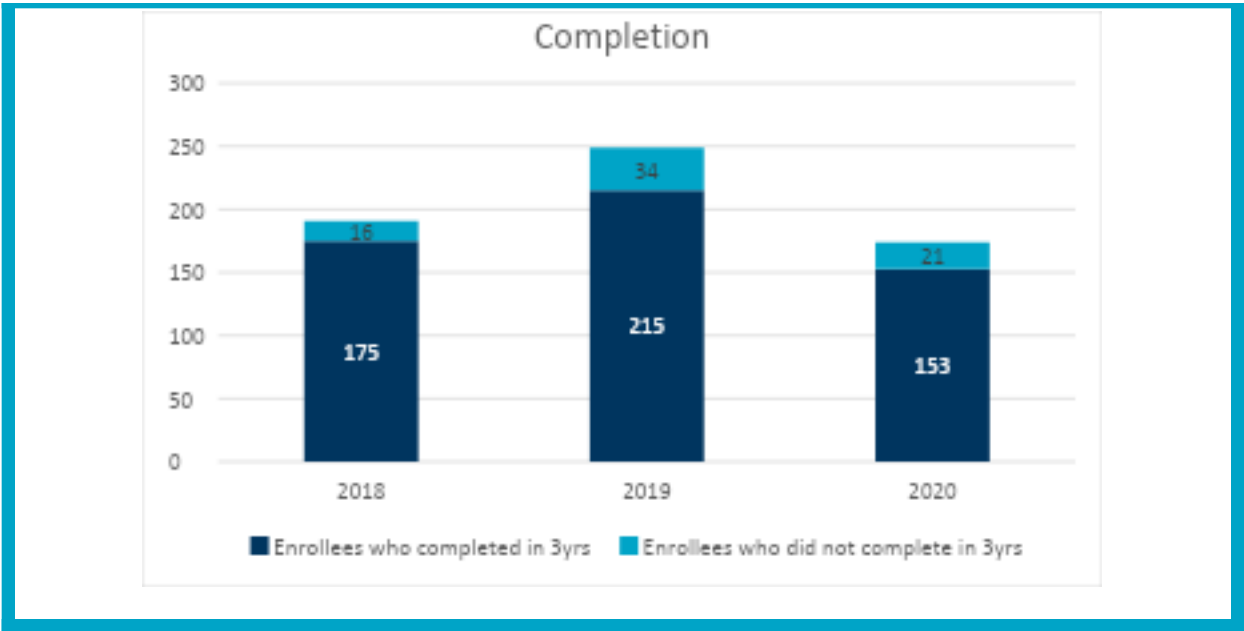
Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	14%	APPROACHING



*Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline), demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased), and state focus areas. Current licensure areas of shortage: Biology (7-12), Chemistry (7-12), Physics (7-12), Foreign Language (K-12), Math (7-12), Math (4-8), Science (4-8), Special Education (K-12)

INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	88%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
MEETS	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
The University of Central Arkansas has a strong education program preparing and supporting teacher candidates with multiple field experience opportunities and effective course instructors. Coursework is aligned, and candidates have opportunities to utilize HQIM. Candidates also have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisors and course instructors. UCA is well regarded by partner schools, and collaborative processes are in place with districts and schools to co-construct clinical experiences. It is evident they have a commitment to continuous improvement practices. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: • By 2026–2027, EPPs will need to provide evidence that experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents have received DESE-recognized coaching training. • UCA should continue planning to meet the state’s one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based EXCEEDS
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction EXCEEDS Most coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates best practices around content instruction, including HQIM and best practices by using specific language and stating the alignment in syllabi, course matrices, and assessments. Specific examples include content syllabi for the Instructional Strategies for K–6 Social Studies (ELSE 3304), Integrated Approaches to Child and Young Adult Literature (ELSE 3305), methods courses with course outcomes, and assignments aligned with national (NCSS) or state standards (AR Comp K–6 ELA), respectively, and content specific strategies for instruction. ELSE 3305 also includes integrating literature across other content areas. The syllabus for Math and Science for Diverse Learners (ELSE 4301) includes an outline of types of activities that support effective instruction. In the Coursework focus group, teacher candidates agreed that their coursework incorporates recognizing and using high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices. They gave many examples including evaluating grows and glows of HQIM materials, evaluating four types of curriculum (specifically mentioning Eureka Math),

annotating HQIM materials, then using them to teach lesson (in Internship1), using charts and tables for HQIM to evaluate materials (including alignment to standards and whether differentiation is included), and Scarborough's Rope mentioned specifically as to how it is used within multiple courses including math and science.

Reviewers observed four courses and most of them incorporated various best practices. In Instructional Strategies for Math and Science K-6 (ELSE 4316) the lesson was focused on implementing HQIM. The instructor provided specific vocabulary associated with the difference between planning and preparing lessons, the process of internalization, using the TNTP protocol, and discussing specific HQIM materials for the course groups to utilize in their assignment. Amplify Science and Eureka Math were used.

The EPP earns the "exceeds" rating for this metric because of their annual evaluation system of program reports. The EPP shared that each fall, programs submit reports to the Dean's office outlining how curriculum and key assessments align with national standards. Additionally, faculty review candidate progress through the EPP's key assessments which are mapped to specific standards. During the annual data day, faculty examine assessment data, identify strength and growth areas and develop action plans to ensure the programs remain aligned with national standards while meeting the needs of candidates.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
EXCEEDS

Coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Coursework also clearly and intentionally provides candidates opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout all grade bands within the licensure area. Specific examples include the Unit Plan Template which requires candidates to align lesson plans to Arkansas K-12 standards, make connections to previous and future learning for K-12 students and provide rationale for decisions to demonstrate candidates understand the connections. This full reflective process allows supervisors to review the narrative information and guide or redirect their teacher candidates, as needed. Another assessment is the Impact on Student Learning Project, which requires candidates to align their lesson plans to AR K-12 standards as part of the process for pre-assessment and post-assessment of K-12 student learning.

In the Coursework focus group, all candidates agreed that all courses reflect on AR K-12 Standards, even in content courses, and all assignments begin with the standards and then build the lesson plan. There is a scope and sequence, connection of standards through each grade level, and in their document lesson plan they look back and reflect on what they previously learned. Many classes focused on the various content areas (ELEM) and then integrated examples of how the science of reading would show up in different grade levels. Instructional Strategies for Math and Science K-6 (ELSE 4316) course observation reviewers noted that the in-course group work used second grade (science) and fourth grade (math) HQIM that candidates were required to analyze and align to AR standards they would be teaching. The instructor gave a specific example and used a slide to provide examples of scaffolds to help with vertical alignment of previous knowledge. This included providing writing prompt stems that candidates prepared possible answers to.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric because of their system to evaluate how Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards are incorporated into coursework. All course syllabi go through a review process by the dean each term to be evaluated for the inclusion of AR K-12 standards. The EPP's key assessments also provide system evidence that standards are incorporated, allowing faculty to verify candidates are learning the standards, how to unpack them and how to vertically integrate across grade bands. Finally, the EPP surveys program completers and school partners about the candidate's ability to "align instruction to Arkansas standards" and consistently scores a rating of "adequately prepared."

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher
MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework providing candidates an opportunity to show proficiency. The Academic Map (AMAP) for each program shows how the EPP structures course completion, including their institution's core required coursework to support the candidate through the program of study and fieldwork. Data-Driven Instructional Planning (ELSE 4331) provides a description for the "Assessment Planning Project and Analysis" assignment that is designed to prepare candidates for their Impact on Student Learning during their future internship semester. Syllabi also indicate prerequisite courses required prior for

current course content. Examples include statements from Behavior Guidance for the Diverse Classroom (ELSE 4302) which notes completion of all program courses prior to Special Education Internship I.

In the Coursework focus group, all six participants nodded yes that courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced. One candidate specifically mentioned two courses within the Foundations of Reading sequence. The first course focused on the lower portion of Scarborough's Rope and the following course focused on the upper portion of Scarborough's Rope.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework EXCEEDS

Most coursework is clearly aligned with AR Educator competencies and AR Teaching Standards, where appropriate, in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills in their required licensure area. Specific examples include content syllabi, for example, Instructional Strategies for K-6 Social Studies (ELSE 3304) with course outcomes and assignments. The MSIT 4312 syllabus incorporates the Foundations of Reading Educator Competencies in course outcomes and specific weekly topics.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants noted that course syllabi include several threads for the various level AR Educator competencies, standards and checkpoints. Every course created must align topics covered and assessments to standards.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric by demonstrating a system to evaluate how competencies and teaching standards are incorporated in coursework. The EPP utilizes the DESE matrices to map course content to state expectations. During program reviews and data analysis sessions, faculty review and update the matrices based on curriculum changes. The EPP's exit, completer and employer surveys are aligned with InTASC standards. Survey results are analyzed in faculty committees and during the annual data day to identify strength and growth areas, and to develop action plans.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience MEETS

Most of the coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned with clinical experiences, as evidenced through the explicit language used in the syllabi and for key assessment instructions. Specific examples include Positive Classroom Environment for K-6 (ELSE 4309) and Sped majors in part of Jr. Block, which requires a field component and assessment; Math and Science for Diverse Learners (ELSE 4301); and Foundations of Reading (ELSE 4311), also contain field components and assessments. Instructional Strategies for Math and Science K-6 (ELSE 4316) notes three specific field assignments. Behavior Guidance for the Diverse Classroom (ELSE 4302) specifically notes "All field assignments are designed around course content." In addition, the Unit Plan Template and Impact on Student Learning Project is utilized to demonstrate candidate knowledge and skills and aligned with experiences the teacher candidate is having in their clinical experiences. Opportunities are provided for candidates to discuss alignment with their course instructor.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants gave specific examples such as the Impact on Student Learning (IoSL) project. First, the candidates use "training data" to learn how to analyze data, then they use "live data" from their clinical experience. Early on, field courses include scaffolded assessments which are all tied to field work, then to Internship 1, where all courses have a required assessment in their placement, preparing them for Internship 2. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. Examples include practice reflecting and receiving feedback on their IoSL project prior to working with live data from their K12 clinical experience.

In the Intermediate Strategies for Math and Science K-6 (EDUC 4316) course observation, reviewers observed that coursework is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. The candidate assignment was to use the Integration protocol for an HQIM. The instructor provided a "what to look for" slide and made a connection to the potential global learning component in the Amplify Science lesson. Using a slide from the MS Dept of Education that highlighted vocabulary used in the integration process, she noted that in the modification process, the candidates will have to conference with their building administrator.

Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their course instructors. As reviewers joined the lesson, they noted that the instructor used a Padlet “HQIM Chalk Talk” with four prompt questions. Two candidates shared what they were experiencing in the field – one had experience with Illustrative Math but not Eureka Math and how there was no gradual release. The other stated that their supervisor suggested that they never take away but only add to HQIM. They also discussed time constraints with curriculum.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas K12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy through their degree credentials, teaching certifications, and PreK-12 teaching experience. In addition, the majority of faculty have specific areas of expertise noted and professional development and training listed. The EPP keeps track of faculty scholarships, support and training. Evidence of scholarship and professional development is present in the examples of annual reviews.

Coursework focus group participants shared that they appreciate that the faculty gives examples within lesson delivery to show practical application. One candidate added, it helps that course instructors share “not just the theoretical but [help us] to visualize the practical” as well. Another added, “if a candidate asks a question, faculty can give a scenario, and our instructors have relevant examples that can be implemented.”

In the Course Observation, Advanced Strategies for ML (MSIT 4328), the reviewers noted that the course instructor shows deep knowledge of Arkansas K12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. The instructor presented their Google Classroom which linked to the standards and competencies for all disciplines and grade levels as well as the course design to build and expand on student skills and development. She was knowledgeable in her lecture, explaining the course and what it looked like for all disciplines. The instructor referred to many different best practices, HQIM for ELA and Math, national standards, and how she used state and national standards across disciplines to teach students how to identify quality materials and assessments.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

EXCEEDS

Course instructors show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework. In the Coursework focus group, participants shared examples that course instructors engage candidates by doing activities alongside candidates, facilitate discussion-based conversation of strategy effectiveness, provide lesson planning feedback (standard alignment assistance, how to strengthen aspects of the lesson, what is good/strong), are extremely responsive to email and make themselves available to meet. One candidate mentioned “If you are not doing well, you are automatically filtered into receiving additional help.” The rest of the group gave thumbs up to support the statement.

In the course observation, Instructional Strategies for Math and Science K-6 (EDUC 4316), reviewers observed the instructor facilitating a Chalk Talk with the class asking questions and having the teacher candidates answer each question on the message board. The questions revolved around HQIM, implementation successes and obstacles, as well as what support would be helpful. Candidates read, commented on the other answers, and discussed as a large group.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric due to their annual evaluation of course instructor effectiveness. Faculty are evaluated annually which includes a one-on-one meeting with the department chair where they discuss their performance and progress towards goals, and goals are established for the next year. The Evaluation of Supervisors AY23-24 evidence provides a narrative of how the data were evaluated and specific changes made in “supervisor training, communication protocols, and support structures”. Another comprehensive evidence piece is the Completer Survey AY23-24 administered to Traditional and MAT completers, with prompts aligned to InTASC Standards. This data can be disaggregated and evaluated by content area as well. The Employer Survey AY23-24 collects employer perception of candidate preparation aligned to InTASC Standards, which in part is a reflection on the effectiveness of course instructors. Survey results are provided in aggregate to the EPP and in content area licensure. Evidence packages for the surveys and evaluations indicate that the data are reviewed and provided to the program coordinators. The “Student Work and Feedback” links provide evidence that most candidates receive

specific, actionable feedback, in some combination of criterion-specific, overall, or both that recognizes achievement and areas for future improvement.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

EXCEEDS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

The sequence of clinical experiences builds off previous experiences and provides opportunities for learning and development. Candidates complete 78 hours of classroom teaching during their Junior Block and in their final year, they complete a total of 450 hours of experience in Internship I (two days per week) and Internship II (five days per week). In Internship II, there is a gradual release throughout the sequence with candidates moving toward 100% of the planning and execution of the lessons.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, at least 80% of participants agreed with or understood how their clinical experience is sequenced to support their development and provided examples. One candidate shared their experiences began with observations, then moved to disciplinary literacy, and then transitioned into implementing classroom assessments and instruction. A music candidate said, "we went into schools to teach private lessons (10 hours a semester starting sophomore year). The following semester we had the opportunity to go observe band or choir rehearsals. We also did classroom management observations." Candidates in other content areas (PE and Elementary) had similar experiences. One candidate said, "I think the program did a really good job in the observation area. We were able to see what it feels like to be a teacher. We had a lot of time to practice."

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, all eight participants agree clinical internships are intentionally sequenced, build knowledge for candidates and include multiple opportunities such as observations, small group teaching and gradual release to full teaching responsibilities in Internship II.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric as evidenced by their evaluation system to continually improve the sequence of clinical experiences. Meeting minutes from the monthly ILPC Committee meeting highlight discussion around the sequence of clinical experiences. In November 2024, the committee reviewed the scope and sequence maps for all clinical experiences across every program.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

EXCEEDS

Candidates are provided with a variety of clinical experiences that provide opportunities to work with students with varied learning needs. Courses require candidates to work with a variety of students, for example, Instructional Programming for Diverse Learners (ELSE 4307) requires candidates to assess and implement weekly interventions for struggling students. In the final internship, candidates are required to create lesson plans that differentiate instruction for various learner groups. In the "ILPC Meeting Agenda" provided by the EPP, program coordinators discuss partnerships to be sure candidates are receiving multiple opportunities to work with various student groups.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, two candidates discussed their experiences working with students receiving support services saying, "Last semester, my teacher was on a team with ELLs, so going from classes like that showed me how to modify and adjust. I have worked with struggling students and high performing students and taking the same lesson and modifying it for all students." Another candidate said, "I saw the same ELL lesson, which was a really good experience and boosted my confidence. The biggest thing my mentor teacher did was teach me to modify while still showing them they still can do the work."

Participants in the Clinical Supervisor focus group also shared how candidates have experiences based on the coursework they are taking. One participant shared that candidates start in a K-3 classroom to observe the lower end of Scarborough's Rope and then they spend time in a rural district for elementary and special education placements.

Some courses are taught on site at a partner school. Candidates have opportunities to practice interventions and assessments and look at student data.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric as evidenced by their evaluation system to continually improve the sequence of clinical experiences. In November 2024, the ILPC Committee reviewed the scope and sequence maps for all clinical experiences across every program, paying careful attention to where field experiences would take place. This review allowed for informed adjustments to ensure candidates have a variety of field experiences and the opportunity to work with students of varied learning needs.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship
MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers
EXCEEDS

Most experienced mentor teachers demonstrate they have the coaching skills to support candidate development. In the "Mentor Teacher Tracker" 38 out of 46 (82%) mentor teachers reported having rubric training and all have at least three years of experience and effective or highly effective summative TESS ratings. On average, candidates rated their mentor teachers highly, with an average score of 2.8 (out of 3) on a satisfaction survey.

Mentor teachers participate in training at the beginning of the semester and are provided with a comprehensive handbook to support them throughout the semester. They utilize a pre observation, observation, and post observation (POP) coaching cycle and the Aspiring Teacher Rubric to provide feedback to candidates.

In the Clinical Experience focus group, most candidates indicated they enjoy working with their experienced mentor teachers, stating they have been "amazing," "inclusive," and "willing to provide feedback in a timely manner." In the Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group, participants provided examples of feedback, coaching, and building trust and rapport. One participant shared they meet bi-weekly with their candidate and problem solve around student issues or other areas of support. Participants also reported staying current on legislation, professional learning, and graduate hours to meet the ever-growing demands of mentorship.

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric due to their evaluation of and tracking systems for mentor teachers. The EPP evaluates mentor teacher effectiveness each semester through a survey given to candidates and university supervisors. These evaluation data are tracked in a spreadsheet that includes mentor teacher qualifications and recent trainings. Data is reviewed annually by the Director of Candidates Services, the Assessment Director, and relevant program coordinators and chairs to determine if mentors need additional support or if certain mentors should not be utilized in future semesters.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers
MEETS

A process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers. According to the MOU example shared by the EPP, there is a set of criteria that mentor teachers must meet that is aligned with guidance from DESE. The EPP provided a database of "Mentor Teacher Data" confirming mentor teacher qualification. This document also serves as a tracker for performance. The EPP evaluates mentor teacher effectiveness each semester through candidate and clinical supervisor feedback.

In the School Partnership focus group, participants shared that the selection of the mentors is completed by the district and provided to the EPP based on subject and grade level need. The MOU outlines the process of the Director of Clinical Experiences working with the partner school to identify experienced mentor teachers for candidates.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors
MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. Overall, candidates gave their clinical supervisors a evaluation. On a 3-point scale, with 3 being above average, candidates gave a 2.76 rating for "provided immediate feedback" and a rating of 2.84 for "shows respect."

In the Clinical Experience focus group, most candidates spoke positively about their clinical supervisor, stating they are willing to help, provide feedback, and are accessible. One candidate said, "Both of mine (clinical supervisors) have been great. I do not feel stressed out when they come to observe." Participants in the Experienced Mentor Teacher focus group could also provide examples of how clinical supervisors support candidates. One participant said, "The supervisor I'm working with is very knowledgeable. She's a retired teacher and still substitutes, so she still has current knowledge. She drops by every other week to check in with both of us, but she checks in individually as well."

In all four of the coaching observations, reviewers noted strong content knowledge. One reviewer said, "The clinical supervisor was knowledgeable of the music standards, best practices in foundational instrumental music classes, and was able to provide concrete, actionable feedback for the candidate to implement in future lessons. He affirmed what the candidate did well, encouraged continued growth in those areas, and identified the key lever(s) that will have the most impact on teacher candidate growth. The feedback was well received."

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates
EXCEEDS

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback. Clinical supervisors are required to conduct three formal observations using the POP cycle throughout a candidate's internship experience. Experienced mentor teachers conduct informal and formal observations and provide regular feedback. All feedback is linked to the Aspiring TESS rubric. Feedback is written and oral, and clinical supervisors are expected to provide feedback within one week of assignments being submitted. Interns receive feedback on their lesson plan, teaching, and lesson reflection as part of the POP cycle.

Reviewers observed examples of effective feedback in the coaching observations. In all four of the coaching observations, reviewers saw evidence of regular feedback and in each post-observation, the clinical supervisors share written and oral feedback based on Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR). Conversations focused on candidate goals and strategies for growth and supervisors built off previous feedback. A review team noted, "The feedback was positive, affirming, but also concrete, actionable, and specific to the candidate's learning and next steps. The candidate received a rating on the ATR rubric with targeted feedback that was linked to the class observation."

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric due to their system for monitoring candidate feedback. Clinical supervisors submit feedback through the EPP's system, Chalk & Wire, which is monitored monthly by the Director of Assessment to confirm all candidates are receiving regular feedback within the expected timeline. Experienced mentor teachers complete a disposition evaluation on their candidate with rating options based on the UCA COE Disposition Rubric and Aspiring TESS Components. This happens mid-semester.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates
MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools
EXCEEDS

Collaborative processes are in place with most districts to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates. The EPP partners with a variety of schools across Arkansas to support teacher candidates with their field experiences and internship. UCA utilizes MOUs to establish expectations for partnerships and these agreements are reviewed and renewed annually. One specific example of a strong partnership is with East End School District where Elementary and Sped candidates engage in literacy assessment and intervention practices, while middle and secondary candidates work with struggling readers. UCA has also engaged with partner districts to implement the Aspiring Teacher pathway allowing undergraduate candidates to serve as the teacher of record in their final semester of the program.

Clinical supervisors also demonstrate a strong collaborative effort with experienced mentor teachers. They work together to rate the summative aspiring TESS evaluation and check in regularly on the progress of the candidates. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants said they have some formal structures in place to collaborate with experienced mentor teachers including a virtual meeting at the beginning of the semester that includes the candidate. Experienced mentor teachers agree with this, saying there is collaboration between the EPP and the school to create a

strong clinical internship to develop teacher candidates. While one EMT noted geography as a barrier to on-site collaboration, the majority mentioned that proximity afforded the clinical supervisor to be onsite more often.

UCA earns the exceeds rating for this metric as evidenced by their continuous improvement to ensure partnerships are mutually beneficial. UCA utilizes advisory boards and working groups to collaborate with partner schools. Program-specific advisory boards meet annually, and the Executive Advisory Board meets twice yearly to co-construct EPP practices. These groups analyze program data, review key assessments and provide actionable feedback. One example is the TESS Ad Hoc Working Group who met to determine the transition to utilizing the ATR rubric. The EPP is currently involving partner schools in discussions about the year-long residency requirements. Another example shared in the School Partnership focus group was that UCA reviewed data and implemented trauma informed practices with the co-op, collaborating on faculty and student training. All seven school partners agreed that UCA is receptive to feedback.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors MEETS

UCA demonstrates a strong commitment to the development and support of their clinical supervisors. UCA utilizes a yearly evaluation of all faculty. This evaluation includes grade distributions, annual goals, summary of teaching efforts and accomplishments. In addition to annual evaluations conducted by UCA, the EPP also collects feedback from candidates and mentor teachers at the end of each term. Feedback is provided directly to the clinical supervisor to further support their growth. In addition to evaluations, clinical supervisors are required to complete professional development. Professional development is offered by UCA and includes topics such as HQIM, Science of Reading, coaching and data analysis. UCA's Director of Assessment provides dedicated training for new faculty and requires training for all supervisors each term. UCA provided agendas from calibration meetings that show evidence of supervisor training, including case studies and discussion about the POP Cycle, Aspiring TESS and giving feedback to candidates.

Clinical supervisors affirmed the EPP's commitment to their development in the focus group. Participants shared the College and Departments offer frequent opportunities for professional development, including attending conferences, university sponsored instructional improvement opportunities, state meetings, and faculty meetings. One participant said, "we are continually challenged and share when we think something should be changed; we join cohorts to make changes to what we all use, and we are invested."

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework EXCEEDS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. All programs have GPA data above 3.0 for admissions, and data shows that all program completer GPA's increased.

EPP tracks data in an Airtable database updated to track progress through program gates. Data is input from multiple people including the program coordinator, course instructor, intern supervisor, and the mentor teacher who complete surveys that connect to the Airtable spreadsheet

The EPP submitted evidence to earn the exceeds rating for this metric. The EPP monitors candidate progress from admission to program completion to ensure readiness for certification and effective teaching. Data from "Gates System" informs the EPPs quality assurance processes by collecting evaluations from multiple sources and measures at key progressions point. Program coordinators and faculty analyze program milestone data to identify areas for improvement, leading to recent changes such as adopting Airtable for tracking, revisions disposition assessments, and enhancing candidate support structures.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are off track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. The EPP provided three examples of individualized support plans based on data from Airtable tracking system. The plans include sections that explain the areas of concern, links to the dispositions or rubric, suggestions for courses of action with candidate input, follow up meeting notes, and progress tracking.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internship. The EPP includes a well-structured clinical internship program with clear goals, expectations, and milestones. There are multiple formal observations, detailed lesson planning, comprehensive unit planning, and impact on student learning assessments. The EPP uses a detailed documentation system to track candidate progress through platforms like Blackboard and Chalk & Wire. The Internship II Handbook (undergrad) outlines week-by-week expectations to keep candidates on track. Eighty-eight percent of graduates become licensed.

In the Clinical Experiences focus groups, participants provided specific examples of their goals and milestones. They cited their rating on Aspiring TESS domain rubric, ALME (Association for Middle Level Education) standards, a portfolio as evidence of met standards and movement through the various gates.

The EPP provided evidence to demonstrate continuous improvements to track and evaluate the effectiveness of the goals and milestones. Each year, every program submits an annual review to look at program growth. They look at unit plans and data to determine where they are getting stronger and where they need to analyze and make changes based on review of material each year. Reviewers did not observe evidence to highlight changes the EPP has made based on findings.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

EXCEEDS

There is adequate evidence candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. UCA assigns an "Impact on Student Learning" project that candidates use to examine their effect on students' learning based on the unit plan they submit and two assessment points from the students. Candidates analyze and reflect on data and are responsible for reteaching and adjusting based on outcomes of data.

Participants in the Clinical Experience focus group shared discussions they have had with their experienced mentor teachers about utilizing pre- and post-test to analyze student learning and using various dashboards to review student data.

In two of the four coaching observations, reviewers saw evidence of discussions around student growth. In one observation, the clinical supervisor and candidate discussed an assessment the candidate facilitated, discussed why it was chosen and how to use the data. The candidate said, "every week, every day we are taking data and putting it in a form, and it was interesting to figure out what to work on..."

The EPP earns the exceeds rating for this metric as evidenced by their continuous evaluation of the "Impact of Student Learning" assessment. The assessment was developed in 2014 with input from various stakeholders. The assessment was piloted in 2014-15 and adjusted based on data and feedback. In 2019, the rubric was updated with K-12 partner input, and through continued advisory boards, the assessment continues to be evaluated. Data from the assessment show steady gains across all criteria since 2019-20 and more consistent performance with decreasing standard deviations. The EPP shared that when challenges arise, such as lower scores in the "Reflection on Unit and Student Learning", the EPP addresses them by forming faculty working groups to ensure consistency and to improve support materials.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive a score of effective on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric. The data show consistently strong performance across three years (2001-2024), with mean scores between 2.4-3.6 across all domains.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided with the support they need if their clinical internship is offtrack. The EPP uses data from the ATR to assess if and in what areas candidates need support in their clinical internship. Responses to those who need support are systematic and differentiated ensuring appropriate support for all candidates. The candidate's supervisor and mentor teacher provide documentation and recommendations for improvement. Candidate progress is also evaluated using midterm disposition evaluations completed by mentor teachers.

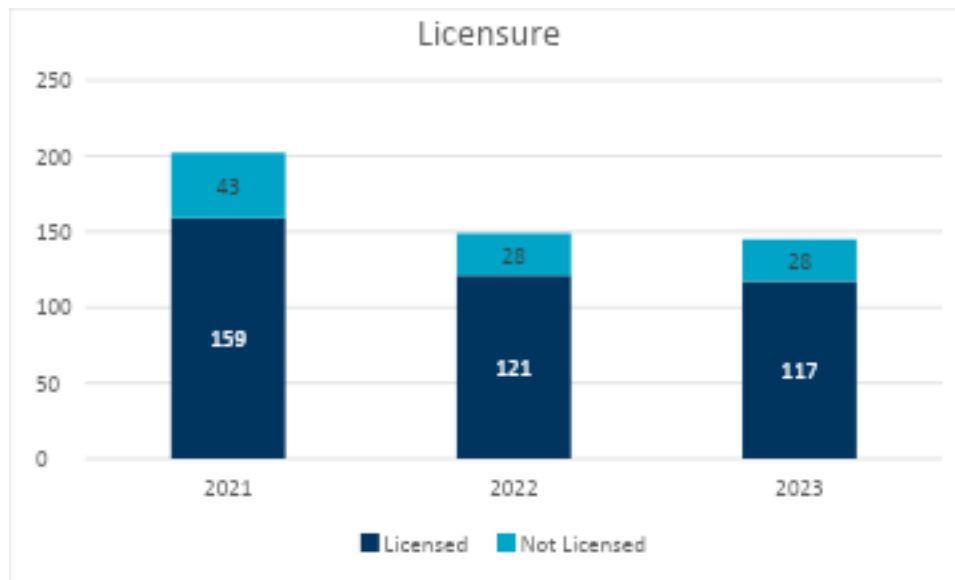
High performing candidates from undergraduate and graduate programs are recognized each year as "Student of the Year" or "Graduate Student of the Year." Students are honored at a pinning ceremony and highlighted as evidenced in the monthly newsletter submitted as evidence.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
MEETS	EXCEEDS	MEETS
Recommendations		
UCA's traditional program meets or exceeds nearly all of the State's targets for EPPs to support Arkansas's workforce needs, including completers who become licensed, work in Arkansas public schools and districts (including priority districts and subjects), and stay in the classroom for multiple years. Recommendations include: Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a</i>)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion.	79.7%	80%	EXCEEDS

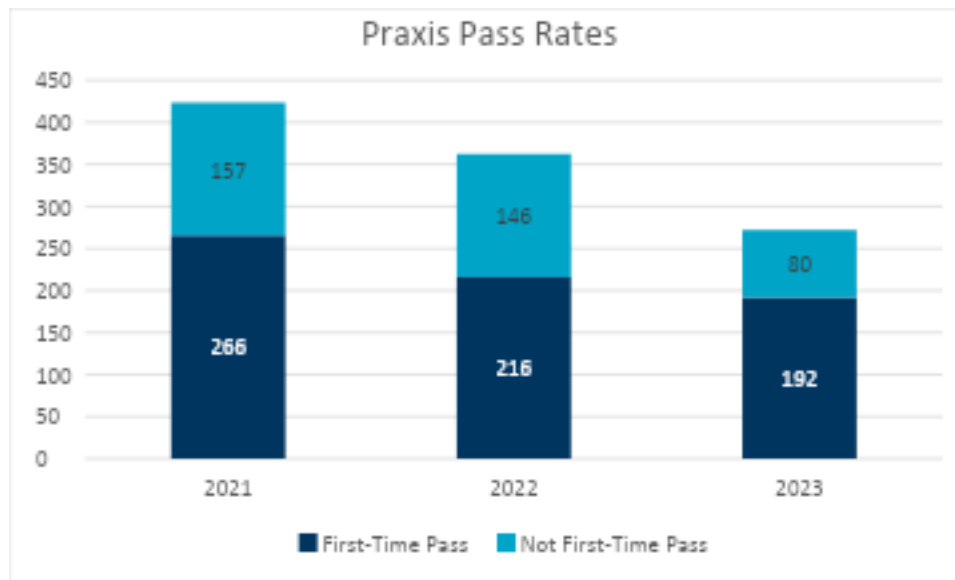


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	n/a	n/a

Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	63.8%	MEETS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	72.2%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not both Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>117</td><td>46</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>139</td><td>60</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>151</td><td>51</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not both Licensed and Employed	2019	117	46	2020	139	60	2021	151	51
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not both Licensed and Employed													
2019	117	46													
2020	139	60													
2021	151	51													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	41.7%	EXCEEDS												
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.															

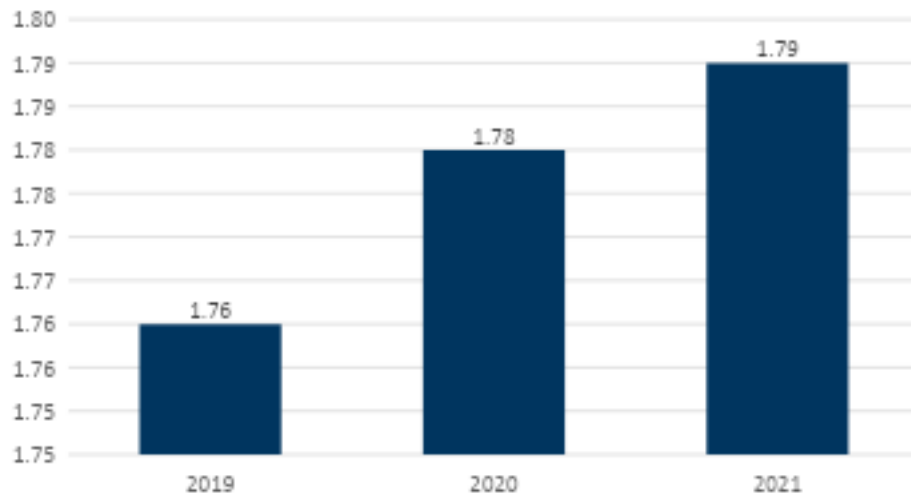
Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	1.88	EXCEEDS

Average Experience 3 Years After Completion



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	68.8%	APPROACHING
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	81%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	41%	MEETS

